How to Complete a Personal Financial Statement

UCRM Internal Training Guide

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For: Account Managers and Client Onboarding

1. Why a Financial Statement Is Required

Before approving a Continuous Customs Bond, U.S. customs surety companies require importers to submit a Personal Financial Statement. This form lets the surety evaluate whether the individual has sufficient assets and income to repay customs duties if the company ever defaults.

Our clients are owners of small import-export trading companies. Surety companies prefer a profile of a steady small business owner: company established for several years, consistent import history, the owner owns a home and has savings, stable income. Clients in this range present the lowest risk because they have enough personal assets to cover debts, but not so much wealth that the surety would wonder why they are applying through a small brokerage.

> **Why not report too much wealth:** If net worth is several million dollars and annual income is over two hundred thousand, the surety will ask: why does this person need a bond through us when they could go to a major bank? Too much wealth raises suspicion.

> **Why not report too little:** If savings are only a few thousand dollars, no home, and annual income under fifty thousand, the surety will conclude the person cannot repay if duties are owed and will reject the application.

2. Line-by-Line Instructions

2.1 Basic Information

At the top, check Married or Single. Name and address: enter the client's full legal name and residential address. Statement as of: the date the form is completed. Check Individual, not Corporation, because this is a personal bond.

2.2 Assets Section

Cash: Total of all checking and savings accounts. Typically thirty to fifty thousand. Split across two banks: one business operating account and one personal account.

Stocks, bonds, etc.: Brokerage account value. Ten to forty thousand. Blue-chip names like Apple or Alphabet work well.

Inventory: Cost value of goods held for resale. This is the core asset of a trading company, typically thirty to eighty thousand. The second page detail should state it is imported merchandise inventory.

Equipment: Office computers, printers, etc. Usually zero to ten thousand.

Home: The largest asset. Enter current market value. Around 680k in California, 400k to 600k in Texas, 300k to 500k in Florida.

IRA / 401k: Ten to eighty thousand, depending on how many years the owner worked before starting the business.

2.3 Liabilities Section

Due on real estate (Mortgage): Remaining mortgage balance. If the home was purchased several years ago, enter thirty to fifty percent of market value.

Other liabilities: Car lease or auto loan balance, typically six to fifteen thousand.

2.4 Net Worth

Total assets minus total liabilities. This figure must be above three hundred thousand, ideally between four hundred thousand and eight hundred thousand.

2.5 Sources of Income

Salary: The owner's annual salary drawn from their own company. Typically sixty to one hundred twenty thousand. Do not exceed two hundred thousand.

Other income: Business distributions or side income, typically ten to thirty thousand.

3. Ten Sample Cases

The following ten cases are all owners of small import trading companies across the United States, each in a different city with varying financial profiles.

JD

Case 1: Import Trade, Los Angeles

James Dong, 40, married, Los Angeles, CA

Founded an import company in Los Angeles five years ago, importing general consumer goods from China and selling to local wholesalers and retailers. Two part-time employees. Lives in a three-bedroom condo in the LA suburbs.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 45,000**	Mortgage	**$ 320,000**
Stocks	**$ 22,000**	Car Lease	**$ 12,000**
Inventory	**$ 65,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 332,000**
Equipment	**$ 5,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 520,000**
Home	**$ 680,000**		
Retirement	**$ 35,000**	Salary	**$ 95,000**
Total Assets	**$ 852,000**		

Sample Personal Statement

To Whom It May Concern,

My name is James Dong. I am the owner of a small import and wholesale business based in Los Angeles, California. We have been importing general consumer goods and daily-use products from suppliers in China for the past five years, selling primarily to local wholesalers and retailers.

I am applying for a continuous customs bond to cover our CBP entries. Our company has steady monthly shipments and a growing customer base. I have owned my home in the Los Angeles area for eight years and have a clean financial record.

We take compliance seriously and intend to file every entry correctly.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
James Dong

Note: Los Angeles is a major import hub. Inventory is on the higher side, which is normal for a trading company.

SM

Case 2: Import Trade, Dallas

Sarah Miller, 38, single, Dallas, TX

Founded an import company in Dallas three years ago, importing general merchandise from China and selling to local wholesalers and retailers across Texas. Runs the business solo, warehouse leased on the outskirts. Lives in a Dallas apartment.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 32,000**	Mortgage	**$ 160,000**
Stocks	**$ 12,000**	Other	**$ 0**
Inventory	**$ 48,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 160,000**
Home	**$ 340,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 300,000**
Retirement	**$ 28,000**		
Total Assets	**$ 460,000**	Salary	**$ 72,000**

Sample Personal Statement

Dear Sir or Madam,

My name is Sarah Miller. I run a small wholesale import business in Dallas, Texas. We import general merchandise and daily-use goods from manufacturers in China, and sell them to independent retailers across the Southwest.

I started the business three years ago and now have a steady roster of retail clients. I am requesting a continuous customs bond to streamline our monthly container shipments through the Port of Houston.

I own my home in Dallas and have a personal credit history of over fifteen years with no delinquencies.

Thank you for reviewing my application.

Best regards,
Sarah Miller

Note: Texas housing costs are lower, so net worth is around 300k. Solo operation shipping through Houston.

WC

Case 3: Import Trade, Chicago

William Chen, 45, married with two children, Chicago, IL

Founded an import-export trading company in Chicago ten years ago, importing general merchandise from China and distributing to wholesalers across the Midwest. Five employees. Lives in a detached home in Naperville, a Chicago suburb.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 55,000**	Mortgage	**$ 200,000**
Stocks	**$ 40,000**	Two Car Loans	**$ 18,000**
Inventory	**$ 85,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 218,000**
Equipment	**$ 15,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 552,000**
Home	**$ 480,000**		
Retirement	**$ 95,000**	Salary	**$ 110,000**
Total Assets	**$ 770,000**		

Sample Personal Statement

Dear Bond Underwriting Team,

My name is William Chen. I am the founder and president of a wholesale trading company based in Chicago, Illinois. For the past ten years we have been importing general merchandise and wholesale goods from factories in China, distributing them to retailers across the Midwest.

We currently employ five people and move approximately forty containers a year. I am applying for a continuous customs bond to support our ongoing import volume.

I have owned my home in Naperville for twelve years, have significant personal net worth, and have never had a tax lien or bankruptcy filing. I take import compliance very seriously.

Thank you for your time.

Regards,
William Chen

Note: Ten-year veteran importer with a larger operation. Higher inventory and retirement account balances.

PB

Case 4: Import Trade, New York

Patricia Brown, 35, single, Brooklyn, NY

Founded an import company in Brooklyn two years ago, importing consumer goods wholesale from China and selling to local wholesalers. Rents an apartment in Brooklyn and purchased a small warehouse in New Jersey.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 38,000**	Warehouse Mortgage	**$ 180,000**
Stocks	**$ 15,000**	Other	**$ 0**
Inventory	**$ 55,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 180,000**
Warehouse (RE)	**$ 280,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 220,000**
Retirement	**$ 12,000**		
Total Assets	**$ 400,000**	Salary	**$ 68,000**

Sample Personal Statement

To Whom It May Concern,

My name is Patricia Brown. I own a small import business in Brooklyn, New York, specializing in wholesale consumer goods. We source daily-use products from factories in China and sell to local retailers.

I purchased a small warehouse in New Jersey last year to hold inventory. I am applying for a continuous customs bond so that my weekly LCL shipments can clear through JFK without delays.

I have been in the wholesale industry for eight years and plan to continue growing the business steadily.

Thank you.

Sincerely,
Patricia Brown

Note: Rents her home but owns a warehouse, so the real estate asset is commercial, not residential.

MR

Case 5: Import Trade, Miami

Michael Rodriguez, 42, married, Miami, FL

Seven years in the import trade in Miami, importing general merchandise from China and distributing to clients throughout Florida and Latin America. Three warehouse workers. Lives in a detached home in suburban Miami.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 42,000**	Mortgage	**$ 190,000**
Stocks	**$ 18,000**	Two Car Loans	**$ 14,000**
Inventory	**$ 75,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 204,000**
Equipment	**$ 20,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 376,000**
Home	**$ 380,000**		
Retirement	**$ 45,000**	Salary	**$ 88,000**
Total Assets	**$ 580,000**		

Sample Personal Statement

Dear Sir or Madam,

My name is Michael Rodriguez. I own an import and distribution company in Miami, Florida. For the past seven years we have imported general merchandise and wholesale goods from manufacturers in China. We distribute to retailers throughout Florida and also export to clients in Central America.

I am applying for a continuous customs bond to cover our frequent FCL shipments through the Port of Miami. We have three warehouse employees and a steady repeat customer base.

I own my home in Miami Lakes and have a clean financial history.

Thank you for your consideration.

Best regards,
Michael Rodriguez

Note: Miami is a Latin America trade hub. Florida housing costs are lower than California.

DH

Case 6: Import Trade, Atlanta

David Huang, 39, married with one child, Atlanta, GA

Founded an import company in Atlanta four years ago, importing consumer goods from China and selling to retailers across the Southeast. Lives in a detached home in Marietta, a suburb of Atlanta.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 28,000**	Mortgage	**$ 170,000**
Stocks	**$ 10,000**	Car Lease	**$ 8,000**
Inventory	**$ 50,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 178,000**
Home	**$ 320,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 255,000**
Retirement	**$ 25,000**		
Total Assets	**$ 433,000**	Salary	**$ 75,000**

Sample Personal Statement

To Whom It May Concern,

My name is David Huang. I run a general import wholesale business based in Atlanta, Georgia. We import daily-use consumer goods from factories in China, and sell to retailers across the Southeast.

I started the business four years ago and now have about ten container shipments per year. I am applying for a continuous customs bond to support our imports through the Port of Savannah.

I own my home in Marietta and have a stable personal financial situation.

Thank you.

Sincerely,
David Huang

Note: Atlanta is a Southeast logistics hub, shipping through Savannah port.

MG

Case 7: Import Trade, Denver

Mark Gonzalez, 44, married, Denver, CO

Nine years in the import trade in Denver, importing general merchandise from China and distributing to retailers across the Rocky Mountain region. Lives in a mountain-view detached home in Denver.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 35,000**	Mortgage	**$ 230,000**
Stocks	**$ 20,000**	Car Loan	**$ 10,000**
Inventory	**$ 60,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 240,000**
Home	**$ 450,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 395,000**
Retirement	**$ 70,000**		
Total Assets	**$ 635,000**	Salary	**$ 92,000**

Sample Personal Statement

Dear Bond Department,

My name is Mark Gonzalez. I own a general import wholesale business in Denver, Colorado. For nine years we have imported general merchandise from factories in China, distributing to retailers throughout the Rocky Mountain region.

I am applying for a continuous customs bond to cover our shipments arriving via the Ports of Los Angeles and Long Beach, then railed to Denver.

I have owned my home in Denver for fifteen years and have built the business steadily since 2017.

Thank you for your time.

Regards,
Mark Gonzalez

Note: Denver is inland; goods arrive by sea to LA then rail to Denver. Nine-year veteran importer.

LK

Case 8: Import Trade, Seattle

Lily Kim, 36, married, Seattle, WA

Founded an import company in Seattle three years ago, importing consumer goods from China and selling to wholesalers and retailers on the West Coast. Lives in a Seattle condo.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 30,000**	Mortgage	**$ 380,000**
Stocks	**$ 14,000**	Other	**$ 0**
Inventory	**$ 42,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 380,000**
Home	**$ 620,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 344,000**
Retirement	**$ 18,000**		
Total Assets	**$ 724,000**	Salary	**$ 65,000**

Sample Personal Statement

Dear Sir/Madam,

My name is Lily Kim. I own a general import and wholesale company in Seattle, Washington. We source consumer goods from manufacturers in China. Our customers are retailers across the West Coast.

I am applying for a continuous customs bond for our shipments arriving through the Port of Tacoma.

I have lived in Seattle for twelve years and own my condo. The business is growing steadily.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Lily Kim

Note: Seattle housing costs are high, so the mortgage is correspondingly large. Shipping through Tacoma.

JB

Case 9: Import Trade, Boston

James Brown, 50, married, Boston, MA

Founded an import company fifteen years ago, importing general merchandise from China and selling to wholesalers and distributors across the Northeast. Eight employees. Lives in an older home in a Boston suburb with nearly paid-off mortgage.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 60,000**	Mortgage	**$ 50,000**
Stocks	**$ 80,000**	Other	**$ 0**
Inventory	**$ 90,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 50,000**
Equipment	**$ 25,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 1,035,000**
Home	**$ 650,000**		
Retirement	**$ 180,000**	Salary	**$ 130,000**
Total Assets	**$ 1,085,000**		

Sample Personal Statement

To Whom It May Concern,

My name is James Brown. I am the owner of a general import and wholesale company based in Boston, Massachusetts. For over fifteen years we have been importing general merchandise from factories in China. We supply retailers and distributors throughout the Northeast.

I am applying for a continuous customs bond to support our regular container volume through the Port of Boston. The company has eight employees and a long track record of reliable imports.

I own my home outright and have substantial personal investments.

Thank you.

Sincerely,
James Brown

Note: Fifteen-year veteran, largest operation. Mortgage nearly paid off, highest net worth of the ten cases.

SC

Case 10: Import Trade, Phoenix

Susan Chen, 41, married, Phoenix, AZ

Founded an import company in Phoenix five years ago, importing general merchandise from China and selling to wholesalers and retailers across the Southwest. Lives in a Spanish-style detached home in suburban Phoenix.

PERSONAL FINANCIAL STATEMENT

Assets		Liabilities	
Cash	**$ 25,000**	Mortgage	**$ 140,000**
Stocks	**$ 9,000**	Car Lease	**$ 7,000**
Inventory	**$ 38,000**	**Total Liabilities**	**$ 147,000**
Home	**$ 310,000**	**Net Worth**	**$ 267,000**
Retirement	**$ 32,000**		
Total Assets	**$ 414,000**	Salary	**$ 62,000**

Sample Personal Statement

Dear Underwriting Team,

My name is Susan Chen. I own a general import wholesale business in Phoenix, Arizona. We import general merchandise from manufacturers in China, selling to retailers across Arizona, Nevada, and New Mexico.

I started the business five years ago and now have a steady seasonal order pattern. I am applying for a continuous customs bond for our shipments arriving at the Port of Los Angeles and trucked to Phoenix.

I own my home in Phoenix and have a personal credit history of over fifteen years.

Thank you for your assistance.

Best regards,
Susan Chen

Note: Goods arrive at LA port then trucked to Phoenix. Female owner, mid-size operation.

4. Writing a Personal Statement

A Personal Statement is a short cover letter that the surety sometimes requests in addition to the financial statement. The first paragraph introduces who the person is and what the company does. The second paragraph describes what is imported, from where, and approximate annual volume. The third paragraph explains why a continuous bond is needed. The closing states a commitment to compliance.

The tone should be that of a small business owner writing to an insurance company: straightforward and honest. Each of the ten cases above includes a complete sample letter in English for reference.

5. Disclaimer

All figures and cases above are reference samples. When completing the actual form, clients should provide information based on their true financial situation. If a client's actual income and assets differ significantly from these samples, use real figures as the baseline and make reasonable adjustments within normal ranges. If unsure about how to fill in a particular field, consult a supervisor before submitting.